



4.04 Confined Space (entry & exit)

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Safe Operating Procedure (SOP) is to provide employees the safe practices and identify all possible hazards for employees to safely enter & exit into tanks for cleaning and maintenance.

LOW HAZARD ATMOSPHERE REMINDER:

The following procedure is only for low hazard atmospheres only!!

- a. 0 - LEL 0 - CO
- b. 0 - H₂S 20.9 - O₂

If the monitor reads anything other than clean air, entry into the vacuum tank is not permitted for any reason. Contact your supervisor for further instructions.

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for all Silverpoint employees

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

Listed below are typical hazards expected in any general confined space entry. It's required that a complete site-specific hazard assessment must be completed and then reviewed/signed off by the project supervisor or designate before each project starts to identify the specific hazards for the project/site.

In British Columbia all hazard assessments must be signed off by a professional body.

WARNING: No one is permitted to enter and work in a confined space unless the following requirements have been satisfied:

- Supervisor and worker have valid H₂S Alive Certificate
- Supervisor and work have valid Confined Spaces training certificate
- An assessment of the confined space has been performed. The assessment must include an air quality deficient atmosphere test and results must be recorded.
- The work must be performed with one worker outside the confined space, standing watch.
- Each worker must have a personal tested gas monitor

5. Confined Space Permit

- 5.1. Alberta OH&S
- 5.2. Silverpoint Corporate Code of Practice
- 5.3. Silverpoint Task List
- 5.4. Silverpoint THA 4.04

Bump Testing Procedure for the GX-2009 only.



If you are using a different type of monitor, follow manufacture's procedure.

6. The following must be performed in a known clean atmosphere :

- 6.1. Press the power/mode button for 1 second until it beeps to turn the monitor on.
- 6.2. The monitor will display the days remaining until a calibration is needed.
- 6.3. The monitor will go thru its warmup cycle and perform a self-test
- 6.4. The monitor will perform an automatic fresh air adjustment ; be sure you are in fresh air.
- 6.5. The monitor should display fresh air readings :
 - 0 – CO2
 - 0 – H2S
 - 0 – LEL
 - 20.9 - O2
- 6.6. Place the calibration cup, hose, and balloon assembly on the bottom of the monitor.
- 6.7. The calibration cup only goes on 1 way, look for the 4 small round indents and match them to the monitor.
- 6.8. Put the small clear tube into the bump gas nozzle.
- 6.9. Kink the clear tubing before you put bump gas into the balloon.
- 6.10. Slowly pull bump test gas canister trigger until a small amount of bump gas starts to flow.
- 6.11. The monitor should alarm (beep/vibrate/flashing red light). All 4 numbers must be flashing.
- 6.12. Remove calibration cup from monitor to allow fresh air to reach monitor heads.
- 6.13. Press the power/mode button to go to peak reading screen and record the numbers of the bump test.
- 6.14. To zero peak reading, press the AIR button until it tells you to release.

7. PROCEDURE

7.1. Entry & Exit of Confined Space

- 7.1.1. Conduct pre-entry gas testing and record the results. Review SOP 4.04
- 7.1.2. Ensure tank level is as low as possible before entering tank.
- 7.1.3. **Assess all specific hazards of the confined space entry. Complete confined space entry permit.**

A SITE SUPERVISOR MUST SIGN OFF ON THE CONFINED SPACE PERMIT, FOLLOW THE CONFINED SPACE REQUIREMENTS.

NO PERMIT WORKERS CANNOT ENTER THE CONFINED SPACE.

- 7.1.4. Carefully enter the tank. Beware of slipping hazards and hidden hazards that may be covered by the



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contents of the tank. Always maintain 3-points of contact.

7.1.5. Clean the tank using proper body position and equipment to prevent injury from twisting, lifting, or pushing.

7.1.6. Once the task inside the tank is completed, exit the tank carefully. Be aware of slipping hazards and obstacles. Always use 3-points of contact.

7.1.7. Clean and inspect the harness, lanyard and any other equipment that forms part of the rescue plan. Record results. Place in a clean container.

7.1.8. Clean and inspect all atmospheric testing equipment. Place back in secure container.

7.1.9. If the work site plan was used as safety standby protocol, report in that confined space is complete.

REMEMBER: If you are in doubt about what to do, call your supervisor.